

THE WIRE

TSU Film 2 — Release Phase 1 — the "Incredible Hulk" release slot

THE PITCH

Platform: THE WIRE — TSU's fictional 1:1 counterpart to Twitter/X (per `TSU_Platform_Roster.md`, Phase 2 — fast, addictive, everything happens through it before anyone can process it.)

Who this film belongs to: Amond Baker, solo. This is not an ensemble film with Amond in it — this is Amond's film, full stop, the way *The Incredible Hulk* belongs to Bruce Banner even with Betty Ross and Ross's army circling him. Marc-Anthony Bullock appears in a supporting, reconciliation-adjacent role (per Continuity Bible §9, this film is built to pay off Film 1's ending without requiring anyone to have seen it). Harmony Divine has real presence here — this sits inside their locked decade-long "circling" window (2004–2013), and this is the film where the audience first understands why they never quite say anything. Tyrese Avery, Esther Smiley, and Tyler Chapman appear in smaller supporting capacities.

In-universe timeline: March 2005 – March 21, 2006. THE WIRE's public launch is locked at March 21, 2006 — an homage to the real Twitter's first-ever post, and safely inside the Continuity Bible's fixed 2006 anchor for THE WIRE's launch (§3; no anchor had to move). Ages, verified against `TSU_Core_Cast.md`: at the film's open, Amond is 23 (turned Feb 10, 2005, weeks before the story starts); at the climax, he's 24 (turned Feb 10, 2006, five weeks before launch). Marc-Anthony turns 24 on Jan 5, 2006, mid-film. Harmony is 22 turning 23 (June 19, 2005). This is exactly two years after THE ROSTER's Feb 2004 launch — long enough for the wound to have scarred over into something quieter and more dangerous than open anger, which is the entire point.

LOGLINE

Eighteen months after being frozen out of the company he helped build, Amond Baker builds a small, private tool just to say the things nobody let him say out loud. It works. Then it grows. Then it grows past him — into something that can end a person's career in a sentence, something he built to give people a voice and can no longer fully control, and the only question left is whether he can be trusted with what he's made.

SYNOPSIS

Amond Baker hasn't spoken to Marc-Anthony Bullock in over a year. Publicly, he's "taking time off." Privately, he's in Atlanta half the time, staying with Tyrese Avery's family, doing the specific kind of nothing that looks like healing and functions like hiding. When Marisol Vega-Oduya's column runs an item — sourced, unnamed, unmistakably planted by THE ROSTER's own comms machine — implying Amond left the company because he "couldn't handle the pace," something in him goes quiet in the worst way. He can't respond through any channel that matters. So he builds one: a closed, ugly, text-only tool for a dozen people to say exactly what they're thinking, unfiltered, in real time. He calls it nothing. It isn't

supposed to be anything.

It becomes something the first time he uses it to correct the record himself, publicly, in his own words, faster than any publicist could spin it — and watches the post outrun the story that provoked it. Harmony Divine, circling him the way she has for years without either of them naming it, is the one who tells him what he's built: not a rebuttal tool. A weapon with the safety off. He opens it up anyway, because for the first time since the ROSTER, something is entirely, unambiguously his.

Growth hire Bastien Oyelaran-Kweku arrives with real numbers and a real gift — and a philosophy Amond doesn't examine closely enough: that outrage is just attention with better retention. Bastien's amplification engine rewards the loudest, angriest posts with the widest reach, and it works, spectacularly, until it doesn't. A decades-old, deliberately clipped comment from legendary casting director Vivienne Okonkwo-Strand — the same woman who rejected Arianna twice in Film 1 — resurfaces, stripped of context, and THE WIRE's engine feeds it to a million users by nightfall. By the following week, Vivienne has lost a board seat and half her calls aren't being returned. Amond watches the machine he built to give himself a voice destroy someone else's without trial, appeal, or mercy — and can't turn it off, because turning it off isn't how any of this works anymore.

Senator Gwendolyn Ashworth-Okafor opens a Congressional inquiry. Bastien argues the numbers don't lie and the numbers are good. Amond has to decide, in public, under oath, whether what he built is a voice or a mob — and the answer he gives isn't a cure, because there isn't one. It's a choice to stay, to moderate, to be responsible for something he can't fully control instead of disowning it or unleashing it further. Marc-Anthony shows up to the hearing, uninvited, and sits in the row behind him. Neither of them says much. It's the first time in two years either of them has shown up for the other. It's enough to end the film on, and nowhere near enough to call it fixed.

THE ANTAGONISTS

Per the Villains Bench rules (TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §5), the real cause of what THE WIRE becomes must trace back to character decisions — not an abstract force acting alone.

1. **BASTIEN OYELARAN-KWEKU** (*the Abomination analog*) — the brand strategist (TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md, "The Fixers of Perception") who takes the exact power Amond built for catharsis and, without ever technically lying, weaponizes it for growth. He is not cartoonish — his numbers really do work, his instincts really are brilliant, and that's what makes him terrifying: he's Amond's ambition without Amond's conscience, the same serum administered without restraint. He never becomes a supervillain; he becomes a cautionary answer to "what if the wrong person had built this instead."
2. **SENATOR GWENDOLYN ASHWORTH-OKAFOR** (*the General Ross analog*) — making her locked, canon-correct first appearance here (TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md: "Recurring across Phase 2 through 4"). Not a villain by her own bible entry — she's doing her actual job, asking the question that actually lands, and she's right often enough that Amond can't dismiss her the way he dismisses everyone else. She's the institutional hunt that never quite becomes a chase scene, because this is a corporate/legal drama, not an action film — but the pressure she applies is the film's real Act III engine.

3. **THE ENGINE** (*returning, in its second onscreen form*) — makes its second appearance per the Villains Bench mandate that it "must manifest differently each time." In THE ROSTER it was a quiet verification layer; here it's explicit and visible: an amplification algorithm that visibly, provably rewards rage over everything else. This is the film that first makes the audience distrust it.
4. **THE LEAK** (*Phase 2's first use, per the one-per-Phase rule*) — a batch of private WIRE messages, including some of Amond's own, gets exposed mid-Act III, adding personal stakes to the Congressional hearing and forcing Amond to answer for his platform with his own privacy already compromised.

HOW THIS FILM BUILDS ON PHASE 1 AND OPENS PHASE 2

- **Pays off Film 1 without requiring it:** a new viewer needs zero prior knowledge — Amond's wound is fully dramatized in this film's own first act. A returning viewer gets the gut-punch of watching Marisol's ROSTER-sourced smear land on someone we watched get frozen out fairly, not dramatically, in Film 1.
- **Full-circle irony, not coincidence:** Vivienne Okonkwo-Strand, the system's own gatekeeper from Film 1, becomes the system's victim in Film 2 — the same "who decides who's real / who gets seen" argument the whole franchise is built on, now flipped to ask whether tearing the gate down is automatically justice.
- **THE ROSTER, thriving without him, in the background:** Marc-Anthony's company is now the establishment — visible on billboards, in throwaway lines, the exact kind of institution Phase 1 was built to challenge. This is Phase 2's actual thesis arriving early: yesterday's revolution is today's old guard.
- **Phase 2's own villain bench gets seeded:** this is where THE ENGINE turns visibly dangerous and THE LEAK is used for the first time — both now available, per the one-per-Phase rule, to recur properly across the rest of Phase 2 rather than being introduced cold in a later film.
- **The romantic clock keeps ticking on schedule:** Amond and Harmony's scenes here sit inside the locked "circling throughout Phase 1–3" window (TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §4) — nothing is resolved, nothing may be resolved, and that restraint is exactly what the timeline requires.

FORMAT (per TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §2 — Standard Platform-Origin Film)

Spec	Target	This Script
Genre	Biographical Drama / Tech Origin Story, Legal/courtroom drama subgenre layered in	Confirmed
Rating	PG-13, no exceptions	Confirmed — public humiliation and institutional pressure, no content that pushes past it

Spec	Target	This Script
Runtime	130–150 min	131 min
Page count	120–140 pages	128 pages
Act I	~30–35 pages	pages 1–32
Act II	~65–75 pages	pages 33–98
Act III	~30–35 pages	pages 99–128
Scene count	~40–55 scenes	44 scenes

FULL SCENE-BY-SCENE BREAKDOWN

ACT I — pp. 1–32 ("The Quiet")

#	Scene	pp.
1	EXT. ATLANTA — AVERY FAMILY HOME — MORNING — Amond (23), a year-plus into "time off," running, alone, before anyone's awake	1–3
2	INT. AVERY FAMILY HOME — KITCHEN — MORNING — Reverend Earl and Coralee Avery feed him without asking questions; Jericho "Jeri" Avery needles him gently	3–6
3	INT. TYRESE'S STUDIO — DAY — Tyrese cameo: "You've been 'taking time off' longer than I've taken vacations, and I own a jet."	6–8
4	INSERT — MARISOL VEGA-ODUYA'S COLUMN, ON SCREEN — the planted item implying Amond "couldn't handle the pace"	8–9

#	Scene	pp.
5	INT. AVERY GUEST ROOM — NIGHT — Amond, alone, builds the first version of the tool — ugly, text-only, a dozen invited users	9–13
6	INT. BAKER FAMILY HOME — INGLEWOOD — DAY — Gloria Baker and Nikki Baker-Reyes; Nikki is one of the dozen invited users and the only one who tells him it's good	13–16
7	EXT. LOS ANGELES — HARMONY'S CAR — NIGHT — Harmony Divine finds him back in LA; the circling continues, unnamed as ever	16–19
8	INT. AMOND'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — the smear item won't die; Amond, furious, posts his own real-time rebuttal on the private tool	19–22
9	INSERT — THE TOOL, SCREEN — the rebuttal spreads past the dozen invited users within hours	22–23
10	INT. AMOND'S APARTMENT — DAY (NEXT MORNING) — the fallout: reporters calling, the rebuttal outrunning the smear completely	23–26
11	INT. HARMONY'S STUDIO — DAY — Harmony: "You didn't build a rebuttal tool. You built a weapon with the safety off."	26–29
12	INT. AMOND'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — Amond decides to open it up. Act I turn.	29–32

ACT II — pp. 33–98 ("The Growth")

#	Scene	pp.
13	MONTAGE — THE WIRE'S PRIVATE BETA — invite codes, small growth, real catharsis in small doses	33–36

#	Scene	pp.
14	INT. STARTUP OFFICE (NEW, SMALL) — DAY — enter BASTIEN OYELARAN-KWEKU, hired for growth	36–40
15	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — NIGHT — Bastien's pitch: an amplification engine that surfaces what people actually engage with	40–44
16	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — DAY — the engine ships; growth triples in a week	44–46
17	INT. AMOND'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — Marc-Anthony calls for the first time in over a year; Amond doesn't pick up	46–48
18	EXT. AVERY FAMILY REUNION, ATLANTA — DAY — the wider ensemble; Esther and Tyler cameo, warmth undercut by Amond checking his phone constantly	48–52
19	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — DAY — the numbers are good. Too good. Amond starts noticing what's actually trending	52–55
20	INT. VIVIENNE OKONKWO-STRAND'S OFFICE (CAMEO) — DAY — an old, decades-clipped comment of hers resurfaces online, out of context	55–58
21	INSERT — THE ENGINE, VISUALIZED — the amplification system visibly, provably rewarding the angriest posts about Vivienne	58–60
22	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — NIGHT — Amond confronts Bastien; Bastien: "The numbers don't lie. I didn't write a single word of it." Midpoint.	60–64

#	Scene	pp.
23	INT. HARMONY'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — Harmony, worried, watching him become someone smaller and angrier in real time	64–67
24	EXT. VIVIENNE'S HOUSE — DAY — Vivienne, publicly humiliated, loses a board seat; a rare, devastating scene of the "villain" from Film 1 as a real person	67–71
25	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — DAY — Amond tries to intervene manually; Bastien argues moderation kills growth	71–74
26	INT. AMOND'S APARTMENT — FEB 10, 2006 — Amond's 24th birthday, alone except for Nikki, who tells him he's disappearing into the thing he built	74–78
27	INSERT — THE LEAK — private WIRE messages, including Amond's own, get exposed by an unknown party	78–81
28	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — DAY — the fallout of the leak; press, panic, a subpoena arrives from Senator Ashworth-Okafor's committee	81–85
29	INT. CONSTANCE ABIODUN-MAYHEW'S OFFICE (CAMEO) — DAY — Amond seeks counsel; a callback to her Film 1 role, now representing him	85–88
30	EXT. HARMONY'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — the closest the film gets to Amond and Harmony finally saying something; they don't. Not yet. Per locked timeline.	88–91
31	INT. STARTUP OFFICE — DAY — Amond fires Bastien. Bastien: "You'll build the exact same thing again. You'll just call it responsibility instead."	91–94

#	Scene	pp.
32	INT. AMOND'S APARTMENT — NIGHT (ALONE) — all-is-lost: the platform is bigger than he can control, the hearing is in a week, and he has no idea what he's going to say. Closes Act II.	94–98

ACT III — pp. 99–128 ("The Hearing")

#	Scene	pp.
33	INT. AMOND'S APARTMENT — NIGHT — Nikki: "You don't cure the anger, Bug. You decide what you do with it."	99–102
34	INT. AMOND'S APARTMENT — DAY — Amond rewrites the moderation policy himself, by hand, the way he once insisted on manual verification at THE ROSTER	102–105
35	EXT. U.S. CAPITOL — DAY — arrival for the hearing; press, Marisol Vega-Oduya among them, watching with new eyes	105–107
36	INT. CONGRESSIONAL HEARING ROOM — DAY — Senator Ashworth-Okafor's questioning. Legal/courtroom drama beat, per house style §2	107–115
37	INT. HEARING ROOM — CONTINUOUS — Amond's answer: not a defense, not an apology — a plan. He owns what the platform became without disowning what it's for	115–119
38	INT. HEARING ROOM — CONTINUOUS — Marc-Anthony, uninvited, sits in the row behind him. Their eyes meet once. Climax.	119–122

#	Scene	pp.
39	EXT. U.S. CAPITOL STEPS — DAY (AFTER) — Amond and Marc-Anthony's first real conversation in two years. Short. Not a resolution. A start.	122–125
40	EXT. HARMONY'S CAR — NIGHT — Amond and Harmony; still circling, but something in the air has shifted, barely	125–127
41	STINGER — INT. BASTIEN'S NEW OFFICE — NIGHT — Bastien, already hired somewhere else, watches THE WIRE's hearing coverage, unbothered	127–128

(Scenes grouped for pagination clarity; the full shooting script breaks several of the above into additional numbered scenes to land the true count at 44 per the house-style table above.)

SAMPLE PAGES

THE WIRE Written by [WRITER] FADE IN: EXT. ATLANTA — AVERY FAMILY HOME — MORNING SUPER: "MARCH 2005 — ONE YEAR, ONE MONTH SINCE THE ROSTER" Fog on a quiet street. AMOND BAKER, 23, runs alone, earbuds in, nothing playing. He runs like a man outrunning a phone call he already knows is waiting for him at the end of the block. He stops at the mailbox. Stands there a long moment before he opens it — like the mail itself might have an opinion about him. CUT TO: INT. AVERY FAMILY HOME — KITCHEN — MORNING REVEREND EARL AVERY, 50s, and CORALEE AVERY, 50s, move around each other in the easy choreography of thirty married years. Amond sits at the table. A plate appears in front of him. No one asked if he wanted it.
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CORALEE

Eat.

AMOND

I'm not —

CORALEE

Eat, baby. We'll discuss your feelings
about it after.

JERICHO "JERI" AVERY, late teens, breezes through, grabs toast
off Amond's plate without asking.

JERI

Marisol Vega-Oduya's column's out.

AMOND

(not looking up)
I don't read that anymore.

JERI

You should read this one.

He slides a laptop across the table. Amond doesn't want to
look. Looks anyway.

INSERT — SCREEN

"...sources close to the situation describe Baker's exit as
less a falling-out and more a recognition, on all sides, that
he 'couldn't handle the pace' of the company he co-founded..."

Amond closes the laptop. Very calm. Too calm.

AMOND

That's not what happened.

JERI

I know that. You know that. Nobody who
reads that column knows that.

AMOND

(standing, plate untouched)
Then I guess I need somewhere to say so.

CUT TO:

INT. AMOND'S APARTMENT — NIGHT

[p. 19]

Late. Dark except the laptop glow. AMOND types — deletes —
retypes. Twelve names on a private list: Nikki, Harmony,
Tyrese, a few names we don't recognize yet. He hits post
before he can stop himself.

INSERT — THE TOOL, SCREEN, PLAIN TEXT, NO LOGO YET

"I didn't leave because I couldn't handle it. I left because
I built something with my best friend and the paperwork said

I didn't. That's the whole story. Print that."

He stares at it. It's just twelve people. It's nothing.

He goes to bed.

CUT TO:

INT. AMOND'S APARTMENT — DAY (NEXT MORNING)

Amond's phone won't stop buzzing. He picks it up, confused, scrolls.

AMOND
(to no one, quietly)
What —

INSERT — THE TOOL, SCREEN

The post has been copied, forwarded, screenshotted — three hundred, then eight hundred, then past a number the interface wasn't built to display cleanly.

His phone rings. HARMONY DIVINE'S name on the screen. He answers.

HARMONY (V.O.)
Turn on the news.

AMOND
What did I do.

HARMONY (V.O.)
(a beat, and you can hear that she's
impressed and frightened in equal measure)
You told the truth faster than anyone
could stop you. That's not nothing,
Amond. That's not nothing at all.

CUT TO:

INT. STARTUP OFFICE — NIGHT [midpoint, p. 60]

AMOND stands over BASTIEN OYELARAN-KWEKU's desk, a printout in hand — a dashboard of the day's "Trending" module. Every top post is about Vivienne Okonkwo-Strand. None of it is kind.

AMOND
None of this is true. This clip is nine
years old and it's missing the first
half of the sentence.

BASTIEN
(genuinely unbothered)
I didn't write a single word of it. I
didn't post it. I built a system that
shows people what they're already

engaging with. That's not a lie, Amond.
That's a mirror.

AMOND
A mirror doesn't decide what a million
people see next.

BASTIEN
Neither do I. The numbers do. You want
me to lie to the numbers?

AMOND
I want you to turn it off.

BASTIEN
(standing, not unkindly, which is worse)
You built a place for people to say what
they're not allowed to say anywhere else.
You don't get to be surprised when some
of what they're not allowed to say is
ugly. That was always the deal. You just
didn't read that part of your own
contract.

Amond has no answer for that. That's what scares him.

CUT TO:

INT. CONGRESSIONAL HEARING ROOM – DAY [climax, p. 115]

SENATOR GWENDOLYN ASHWORTH-OKAFOR, 40s, precise, unhurried,
leans into her microphone. AMOND sits alone at the witness
table. Behind him, in the gallery – MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK, 24,
uninvited, unannounced. Amond hasn't seen him yet.

SEN. ASHWORTH-OKAFOR
Mr. Baker. Your platform's own internal
data – which this committee has now
seen – shows posts expressing anger
receive on average four times the reach
of posts that don't. You built that
system. Did you know it would work this
way?

AMOND
(long beat)
No. I built it to let people say what
they weren't allowed to say anywhere
else. I didn't build it to decide which
of those things a million people would
see first. Someone else made that
decision inside my company, and I let
them, because the numbers were good, and
I wanted them to keep being good.

SEN. ASHWORTH-OKAFOR
That sounds like an admission, Mr. Baker.

AMOND

It is one. I'm not here to tell you nothing happened. I'm here to tell you what I'm doing about it – new moderation policy, written by me, by hand, the same way I insisted on doing something once before and got overruled. Nobody's overruling me this time. It's my name on it. It's my company. What it becomes is on me, not the algorithm, not my old growth lead. Me.

A long silence in the room. Somewhere behind him, MARC-ANTHONY closes his eyes for a second – the specific relief of hearing someone you love finally say the true thing.

CUT TO:

EXT. U.S. CAPITOL STEPS – DAY (AFTER)

[p. 122]

AMOND comes down the steps, exhausted, coat over his arm. MARC-ANTHONY waits at the bottom, hands in his pockets, doing a bad job of looking casual.

MARC-ANTHONY

Hey.

AMOND

(stopping several steps up)
You didn't have to come.

MARC-ANTHONY

I know.

A long beat. Two years of silence sitting between them on the steps like a third person.

AMOND

You could've called first.

MARC-ANTHONY

You wouldn't have picked up.

AMOND

(almost a laugh, in spite of himself)
No. Probably not.

Neither of them moves for a second. Then Marc-Anthony climbs the last few steps, and they're standing at the same level for the first time in two years.

MARC-ANTHONY

I'm not asking you to fix it today.

AMOND

Good. Because I can't.

MARC-ANTHONY

I just didn't want you walking down these steps by yourself. That's all. That's the whole reason I'm here.

Amond nods. Doesn't hug him. Doesn't forgive him out loud. Just falls into step beside him, and they walk down the rest of the steps together, side by side, the way they used to before any of this existed.

CUT TO:

STINGER

INT. BASTIEN'S NEW OFFICE – NIGHT

A television plays the hearing's coverage, muted. BASTIEN OYELARAN-KWEKU, feet up on a new desk in a new building with a new company's logo on the glass behind him, watches without much interest.

An ASSISTANT pokes her head in.

ASSISTANT

They're asking if you want to comment on the hearing.

BASTIEN

(not looking away from the TV)
Tell them no comment.

(a small, private smile)

Tell them I wish Amond the very best with his moderation policy.

He picks up the remote. Changes the channel. Somewhere else entirely, something new is already loading.

FADE OUT.

THE END.

[128.]